

CHALLENGES FOR EVS IN INDIA

Electric Vehicles have been making inroads into India but they still have huge challenges to overcome

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go about our daily personal and professional lives.

COVID-19 and associated

lockdowns encouraged remote work, but it also promoted rise in energy prices across the world, which analysts say is the highest in seven years due to reduced demand for gasoline. India, a country with the third largest road network in the world and the third largest primary energy consumer after China and the United States, has 295.8 million vehicles (as of 2019) on the road. During the peak of the second COVID-19 wave in India, the already high fuel prices skyrocketed by a further 8.50 per litre, severely affecting how the average Indian commutes.

Rising fuel prices encouraged Indians to seek out other cost-effective options. A much-needed impetus also came from the Government of India that promoted the adoption and use of electric vehicles (EVs) with the aim to reduce dependence on crude oil, whose import alone satiates 84% of India's energy needs.

CURRENT STATE OF THE INDIAN EV MARKET

As of 2019, China tops the combined BEV and PHEV market followed by Europe, and the US in the distance. As with most major economies today, India too wants to eventually move away from internal combustion engine (ICE) vehicles to battery electric vehicles (BEVs), plug-in hybrid electric vehicles (PHEVs), fuel-cell vehicles (FCVs), and the works.

It can be argued with a fair degree of conviction that no period, since after World War II, has evinced sweeping changes in the world order than in the past 30-odd months. This time has seen the breakout of a devastating pandemic and a major global conflict between Russia and Ukraine that questioned every major nation's ideological and political stance. While the devastating effects are beyond reconciliation, these events have opened new avenues in other areas changing the fundamental paradigm how we